A-A-53863
16 March 1989

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

FORCEPS, DRESSING, Straight, 5-1/2 Inch

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description as a replacement for Military Specification MIL-F-36706, which is cancelled.

This commercial item description covers a tweezer-style straight dressing forceps, suitable for use in surgical procedures.

Salient characteristics:

General. The forceps shall be 5-1/2 inches in length. The handles shall incorporate a stop pin or a guide pin with accepting hole and serrations. As an alternate, the handles need not incorporate a stop or guide pin. The jaw serrations need not interdigitate.

Material. The material of the forceps shall be Class 4 martensitic stainless steel or Class 6 Type 430 ferritic stainless steel in accordance with ASTM Designation F 899.

Style, design and dimensions. The forceps shall be in accordance with Defense Personnel Support Center (DPSC) Drawing No. 20631.

Hardness. The forceps fabricated from Class 4 steel shall have a Rockwell Hardness C scale (HRC) of 38 to 46. Forceps fabricated from Class 6 steel shall have a Rockwell Hardness C Scale (HRC) of 20 to 30 when tested in accordance with ASTM Designations E 18 or E 92 whichever is applicable. Conversion of hardness values shall be in accordance with ASTM Designation E 140.

Finish. The forceps shall be mirror, satin or matte finish. The matte finish shall exhibit a uniform non-directional surface texture equivalent to that produced by lightly blasting the prepared surface with fine abrasives under pressure.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Passivation. The forceps shall be properly passivated.

Corrosion resistance. The forceps fabricated from Class 4 or Class 6 steel shall show no evidence of corrosion or plating of copper when tested in accordance with ASTM Designation F 1089, Corrosion Testing of Surgical Instruments.

Performance. The jaw serrations shall be uniform in depth, pitch angle, and spacing and be fully formed. Upon closing, the jaw misalignment shall be 0.020 inch maximum.

Identification marking and labeling. The forceps shall be legibly marked with the contractor's name or trademark and the word "stainless". Foreign manufactured forceps shall bear the name of the county of origin.

Workmanship. Forceps shall be processed in such a manner as to be uniform and free from cracks, pits, burrs, sharp edges, scale, rough areas, corrosion, grind or tool marks, and dirt or polishing materials.

Visual and dimensional examination. Forceps shall be examined to verify that design, construction and workmanship are in accordance with applicable requirements.

Materials. The supplier shall be responsible for performing tests to assure that materials are in accordance with requirements.

Unit. Each (EA). One forceps, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. Unit of product for examination purposes shall be one forceps. Sampling shall be level II and an AQL of 1.0.

Examination. Examination shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. Unit of product for test purposes shall be one forceps. Sampling shall be level S-2 and an AQL of 1.0.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and or order.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026l0-26T09:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

| NSN | ITEM IDENTIFICATION |
|---|---|
| 6515-00-333-3600 | FORCEPS, DRESSING, Straight, 5-1/2 Inch |

Ordering data (Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling, and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6515-4465



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS: In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form for use in submitting comments and suggestions for improvements. All users of military standardization documents are invited to provide suggestions. This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge (DO NOT STAPLE), and mailed. In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, was too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems. Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document. If block 7 is filled out, an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

(Fold along this line)

(Fold along this line)

DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

NO POSTAGE NECESSARY IF MAILED IN THE UNITED STATES

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO 4966 WASHINGTON D C

POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY THE DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

Commander
Defense Personnel Support Center
ATTN: DPSC-RSTE
2800 South 20th Street
Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19101-8419

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T09:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

# STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

*(See Instructions – Reverse Side)*

| 1 DOCUMENT NUMBER | 2 DOCUMENT TITLE |
|---|---|
| A-A-53863 | FORCEPS, DRESSING, Straight, 5-1/2 Inch |

| 3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION | 4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)* |
|---|---|
| | ☐ VENDOR |
| | ☐ USER |
| b ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* | ☐ MANUFACTURER |
| | ☐ OTHER *(Specify)* |

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6. REMARKS

| 7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional | b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional |
|---|---|
| c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional | 8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)* |

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.